



IT Software Procurement Policy

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1. Objective:

- 1.1 This policy defines a controlled and secure process for procurement, licensing, and deployment of software on all systems connected to the PCL network, ensuring compliance, cybersecurity resilience, and legal protection.

2. Scope:

- 2.1 This policy applies to:

- Operating systems and application software
- Cloud, SaaS, AI, automation, and analytics tools
- Open-source, freeware, shareware, and licensed software
- Vendor-supplied embedded or bundled software

3. Applicability:

- 3.1 This policy shall be applicable to all employees, departments, contractors, and third parties using software on PCL-managed or PCL-connected systems.

4. Current Risk Context:

- 4.1 Decentralized software procurement by business units introduces risks including:

- Malware and ransomware infections
- License violations and legal penalties
- Data leakage through unvetted SaaS and AI tools
- Absence of patching and vulnerability management

5. Policy Statement:

- 5.1 All software must be approved, procured, licensed, and deployed by IT.

- 5.2 Business units are prohibited from:

- Directly purchasing or subscribing to software
- Installing freeware, cracked, or trial software
- Using personal or vendor-provided licenses on PCL systems

- 5.3 Software identified after deployment without IT approval shall be removed immediately.

6. Software Procurement Workflow

- 6.1 Business submits functional requirement to IT



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6.2 IT evaluates:

- Security posture and vendor reputation
- Data handling and privacy risks
- Integration and compatibility

6.3 IT approves or rejects software

6.4 Procurement manages licensing and contracts

6.5 IT performs secure installation and configuration

6.6 Software recorded in license and asset registers

7. Cyber Security & Compliance Controls

7.1 All approved software must:

7.1.1 Be licensed to Pakistan Cables Limited

7.1.2 Support MFA, encryption, and access controls

7.1.3 Comply with PCL Information Classification standards

7.1.4 Undergo periodic vulnerability and usage review

7.1.5 Any software found non-compliant with defined security standards shall be blocked from network access until restored to compliance.

8. AI, Cloud & SaaS Controls

8.1 AI and SaaS tools must undergo data protection and risk assessment

8.2 Entry of confidential or restricted data into external tools is prohibited unless explicitly approved

8.3 Shadow AI and unsanctioned SaaS usage is strictly prohibited

9. Audits & Reporting

9.1 The IT Department shall monitor software installations and usage.

9.2 Compliance audit and license reconciliation reports shall be submitted to the Chief Executive Officer (CEO) for review and record.

9.3 Any non-compliant software/applications shall be removed from the network.

10. Enforcement & Review

10.1 Non-compliance may lead to software isolation or procurement rejection.



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- 10.2 Any exceptions to this policy shall require prior written approval from the Chief Executive Officer (CEO).



APPROVED BY

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER